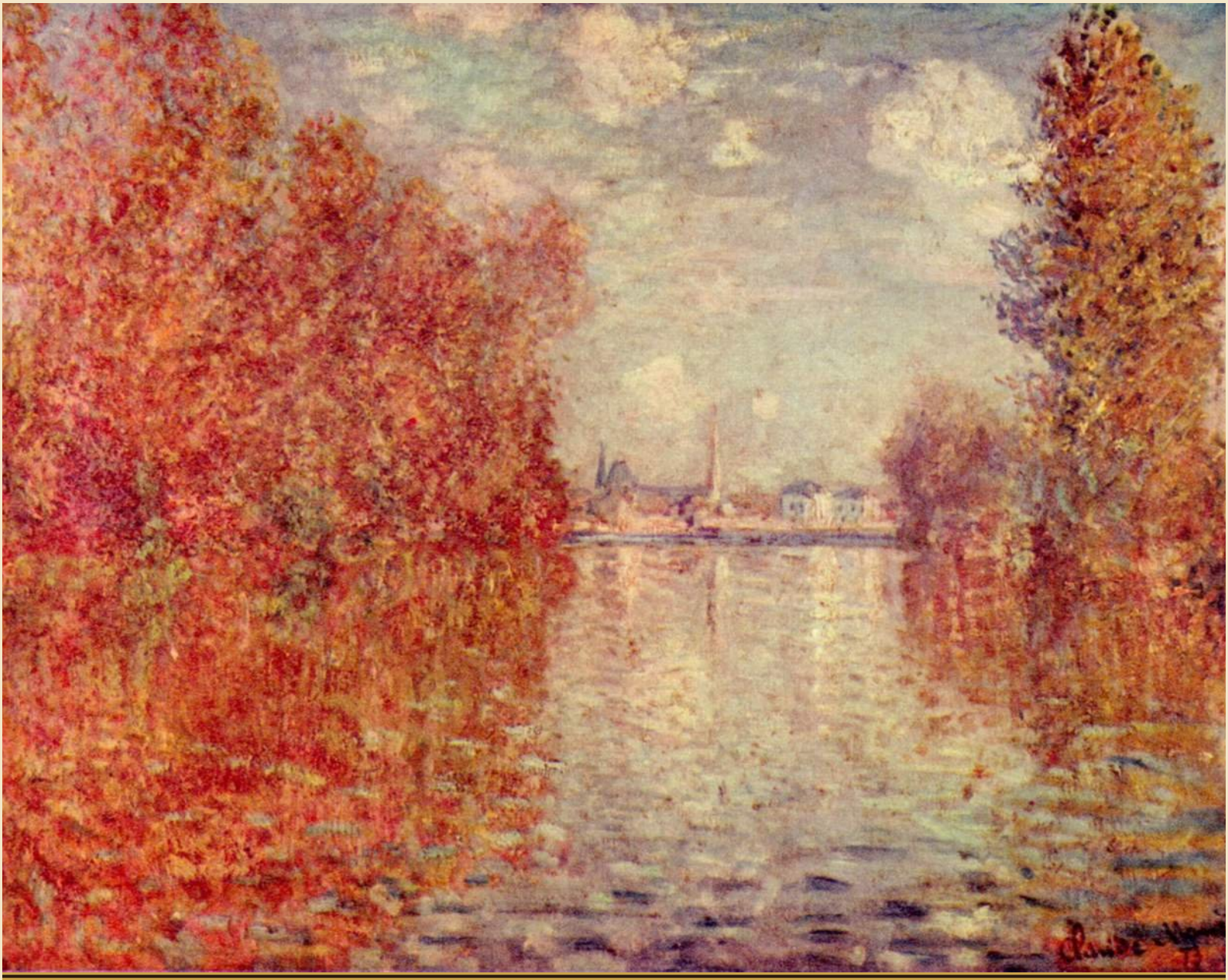


Siddhartha

Hermann Hesse · 1922

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

12 lessons of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 3 weeks

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at five rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

Cover: Claude Monet, Autumn at Argenteuil (1873). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–12), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at five rigor levels

Grades: 6–8 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). **Weeks:** 3. **Lessons:** 12 × 90 minutes.

Essential questions

- What does Siddhartha suggest about the search for self-knowledge?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about experience versus teaching?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about the unity of all things?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about the river and time?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about love and attachment?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the novel.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: RL.7.1, RL.7.2, RL.7.3, RL.7.4, RL.7.6, W.7.1, RL.9-10.2, AP.RL.2, CF.RL.2, GR.RL.2
Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Whole-book test; Final essay
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has five rigor levels; the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28

4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	The Son of the Brahmin With the Samanas Gotama Awakening Kamala	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the search for self-knowledge* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the search for self-knowledge • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	With the Childlike People Sansara By the River The Ferryman The Son	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*experience versus teaching* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Annotation check and vocabulary game • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Om Govinda	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*the unity of all things* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the unity of all things • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: The Son of the Brahmin

Focus: restlessness despite privilege

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha, a gifted Brahmin's son loved by everyone, including his devoted friend Govinda, feels that the teachings and rituals of his elders have not given him inner peace. He asks his father for permission to join the wandering ascetics called Samanas; his father refuses, but Siddhartha stands silently all night until his father consents. Govinda goes with him.

Background: Brahmins were the priestly caste in ancient India; the Upanishads and the idea of Atman (the inner self) shape Siddhartha's questions. Hesse, a German writer, studied Indian thought and wrote during the years after World War I.

Significance: The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are ablution, focused, ascetics, pristine, invocation. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution." Webster's says: The act of washing or cleansing. Now the word history: "ablution": ab- (Latin ab, "away from"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "focus": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "ascetic": as- (Latin ad, "to") + -ic (Greek -ikos, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Brahmins were the priestly caste in ancient India; the Upanishads and the idea of Atman (the inner self) shape Siddhartha's questions. Hesse, a German writer, studied Indian thought and wrote during the years after World War I. Why does this chapter matter? The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see characterization, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to restlessness despite privilege.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Characterization, Setting, Symbolism.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *After the usual time of the exercise in meditation had passed, Govinda rose. The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution. He called Siddhartha's name. Siddhartha did not answer. Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe. Thus sat he, wrapped up in contemplation, thinking Om, his soul sent after the Brahman as an arrow.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Setting, Symbolism: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "The Son of the Brahmin," how does Hesse show restlessness despite privilege? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about restlessness despite privilege, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes restlessness despite privilege. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
ablution	The act of washing or cleansing	*The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution.*	"ablution": ab- (Latin ab, "away from"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
focused	(Opt.) A point in which the rays of light meet, after being reflected or refrcted, and at which the image is formed	*Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.*	"focus": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
ascetics	Extremely rigid in self-denial and devotions	*I came to tell you that it is my longing to leave your house tomorrow and go to the ascetics.*	"ascetic": as- (Latin ad, "to") + -ic (Greek -ikos, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
pristine	Belonging to the earliest period or state	*Was not Atman in him, did not the pristine source spring from his heart?*	"pristine": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
invocation	The act or form of calling for the assistance or presence of some superior being	*The sacrifices and the invocation of the gods were excellent—but was that all?*	"invocation": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + voc (Latin vocare, "to call") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
protruding	To thrust forward	*Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.*	"protrude": pro- (Latin pro, "forward, for"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
partaking	To take a part, portion, lot, or share, in common with others	*For a long time, Siddhartha had been partaking in the discussions of the wise men, practising debate with Govinda, practising with Govinda the art of reflection, the service of meditation.*	"partake": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
wavered	To play or move to and fro	*Siddhartha wavered to the side, as he tried to walk.*	"waver": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
crouched	Marked with the sign of the cross	*As he slowly left on stiff legs in the first light of day the still quiet town, a shadow rose near the last hut, who*	"crouched": -ed (Old English -ed, past or "having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		had crouched there, and joined the pilgrim—Govinda.	
merciless	Destitute of mercy	*Behind them blew a hot scent of quiet passion, of destructive service, of merciless self-denial.*	“merciless”: -less (Old English -leas, "without"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What is Siddhartha's family background?
   A. He is a merchant's son
   B. He is the son of a Brahmin
   C. He is a ferryman's son
   D. He is a prince
2. Who is Siddhartha's closest friend?
   A. Govinda
   B. Gotama
   C. Kamaswami
   D. Vasudeva
3. Whom does Siddhartha want to join?
   A. The soldiers
   B. The Brahmin priests
   C. The Samanas
   D. The merchants
4. How does Siddhartha win his father's permission?
   A. By arguing loudly
   B. By fasting for a month
   C. By standing silently all night
   D. By running away
5. What does Siddhartha seek that rituals have not given him?
   A. Wealth
   B. Fame

C. A wife

D. Inner peace and knowledge of Atman

6. In the line “The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening’s ablution.”, what does “ablution” most nearly mean?

A. Extremely rigid in self-denial and devotions

B. (Opt.) A point in which the rays of light meet, after being reflected or refrcted, and at which the image is formed

C. The act of washing or cleansing

D. Belonging to the earliest period or state

7. In the line “Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.”, what does “focused” most nearly mean?

A. Extremely rigid in self-denial and devotions

B. (Opt.) A point in which the rays of light meet, after being reflected or refrcted, and at which the image is formed

C. The act of washing or cleansing

D. Belonging to the earliest period or state

Answer key: 1. B (He is the son of a Brahmin); 2. A (Govinda); 3. C (The Samanas); 4. C (By standing silently all night); 5. D (Inner peace and knowledge of Atman); 6. C (The act of washing or cleansing); 7. B ((Opt.) A point in which the rays of light meet, after being reflected or refrcted, and at which the image is formed)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “The Son of the Brahmin,” how does Hesse show restlessness despite privilege? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Son of the Brahmin develops the idea of restlessness despite privilege. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in The Son of the Brahmin to complicate the reader's understanding of restlessness despite privilege. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate The Son of the Brahmin within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of restlessness despite privilege responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads The Son of the Brahmin as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of restlessness despite privilege. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *I came to tell you that it is my longing to leave your house tomorrow and go to the ascetics.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ascetics” most nearly mean?

   A. Marked with the sign of the cross

   B. Destitute of mercy

   C. Extremely rigid in self-denial and devotions

   D. To play or move to and fro

2. *After the usual time of the exercise in meditation had passed, Govinda rose. The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening’s ablution. He called Siddhartha’s name. Siddhartha did not answer. Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe. Thus sat he, wrapped up in contemplation, thinking Om, his soul sent after the Brahman as an arrow.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Son of the Brahmin”?

   A. Shameless return

   B. Restlessness despite privilege

   C. Bingley returns

   D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

SAT key: 1. C (Extremely rigid in self-denial and devotions); 2. B (Restlessness despite privilege)

Lesson 2: With the Samanas

Focus: self-denial as a path

Teacher only · spoilers

With the Samanas, Siddhartha learns fasting, enduring pain, and meditations that let his self pass into animals and objects. Yet after three years he concludes these are only escapes from the self, not true release. When rumors spread of Gotama, the Buddha, he and Govinda leave; Siddhartha masters the old Samana with his gaze before departing.

Background: Asceticism—strict self-denial—was a widespread spiritual practice in ancient India.

Significance: Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are numbing, nirvana, festering, cowered, numbness. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life." Webster's says: Enfeebled in, or destitute of, the power of sensation and motion. Now the word history: "numb": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "nirvana": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "fester": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Asceticism—strict self-denial—was a widespread spiritual practice in ancient India. Why does this chapter matter? Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for theme.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see theme, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to self-denial as a path.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Theme, Characterization, Imagery.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of theme. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Silently, Siddhartha exposed himself to burning rays of the sun directly above, glowing with pain, glowing with thirst, and stood there, until he neither felt any pain nor thirst any more. Silently, he stood there in the rainy season, from his hair the water was dripping over freezing shoulders, over freezing hips and legs, and the penitent stood there, until he could not feel the cold in his shoulders and legs any more, until they were silent, until they were quiet. Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Theme, Characterization, Imagery: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "With the Samanas," how does Hesse show self-denial as a path? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about self-denial as a path, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes self-denial as a path. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
numbing	Enfeebled in, or destitute of, the power of sensation and motion	*It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short*	"numb": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up

		numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life.	(Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
nirvana	In the Buddhist system of religion, the final emancipation of the soul from transmigration, and consequently a…	*And Siddhartha: "He has lived for sixty years and has not reached the nirvana.*	"nirvana": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
festering	To generate pus	*Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*	"fester": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
cowered	To stoop by bending the knees	*Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*	"cower": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
numbness	The condition of being numb	*We find comfort, we find numbness, we learn feats, to deceive others.*	"numbness": -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
thirsted	A sensation of dryness in the throat associated with a craving for liquids, produced by deprivation of drink, or by…	*I always thirsted for knowledge, I have always been full of questions.*	"thirst": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
breaths	The air inhaled and exhaled in respiration, air which, in the process of respiration, has parted with oxygen and has…	*Siddhartha sat upright and learned to breathe sparingly, learned to get along with only few breaths, learned to stop breathing.*	"breath": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
submerged	To put under water	*He possessed, so the believers said, the highest enlightenment, he remembered his previous lives, he had reached the nirvana and never returned into the cycle, was never again submerged in the murky river of physical forms.*	"submerge": sub- (Latin sub, "under"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

mumbled	To speak with the lips partly closed, so as to render the sounds inarticulate and imperfect	*And Govinda mumbled a verse to himself, a verse from an Upanishad:*	"mumble": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
meditate	To keep the mind in a state of contemplation	*He'll turn seventy and eighty, and you and me, we will grow just as old and will do our exercises, and will fast, and will meditate.*	"meditate": -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. What do the Samanas practice?
   A. Farming
   B. Trading goods
   C. Warfare
   D. Fasting and self-denial
2. What can Siddhartha do in meditation?
   A. Fly
   B. Speak to the dead
   C. See the future
   D. Let his self pass into animals and things
3. What does he conclude about these practices?
   A. They are perfect
   B. They bring wealth
   C. They should be taught to all
   D. They are only temporary escapes from the self
4. Who is rumored to have attained enlightenment?
   A. Gotama, the Buddha
   B. His father

C. Vasudeva

D. Kamala

5. How does Siddhartha respond to the old Samana's anger?

A. He silences him with his gaze

B. He fights him

C. He promises to return

D. He apologizes

6. In the line “It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life.”, what does “numbing” most nearly mean?

A. To generate pus

B. Enfeebled in, or destitute of, the power of sensation and motion

C. In the Buddhist system of religion, the final emancipation of the soul from transmigration, and consequently a…

D. To stoop by bending the knees

7. In the line “And Siddhartha: “He has lived for sixty years and has not reached the nirvana.”, what does “nirvana” most nearly mean?

A. To stoop by bending the knees

B. To generate pus

C. In the Buddhist system of religion, the final emancipation of the soul from transmigration, and consequently a…

D. Enfeebled in, or destitute of, the power of sensation and motion

Answer key: 1. D (Fasting and self-denial); 2. D (Let his self pass into animals and things); 3. D (They are only temporary escapes from the self); 4. A (Gotama, the Buddha); 5. A (He silences him with his gaze); 6. B (Enfeebled in, or destitute of, the power of sensation and motion); 7. C (In the Buddhist system of religion, the final emancipation of the soul from transmigration, and consequently a…)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.2, W.7.1): In “With the Samanas,” how does Hesse show self-denial as a path? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): Analyze how With the Samanas develops the idea of self-denial as a path. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses theme in With the Samanas to complicate the reader's understanding of self-denial as a path. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate With the Samanas within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of self-denial as a path responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads With the Samanas as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of self-denial as a path. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “festering” most nearly mean?

   A. To generate pus

   B. To keep the mind in a state of contemplation

   C. To speak with the lips partly closed, so as to render the sounds inarticulate and imperfect

   D. To put under water

2. *Silently, Siddhartha exposed himself to burning rays of the sun directly above, glowing with pain, glowing with thirst, and stood there, until he neither felt any pain nor thirst any more. Silently, he stood there in the rainy season, from his hair the water was dripping over freezing shoulders, over freezing hips and legs, and the penitent stood there, until he could not feel the cold in his shoulders and legs any more, until they were silent, until they were quiet. Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “With the Samanas”?

   A. Self-denial as a path

   B. Reflections on love

   C. Destroying the companion

   D. Family dynamics and anticipation

SAT key: 1. A (To generate pus); 2. A (Self-denial as a path)

Lesson 3: Gotama

Focus: the teacher and the teaching

Teacher only · spoilers

In the grove of Jetavana, Siddhartha and Govinda hear Gotama teach. Govinda joins the Buddha's followers. Siddhartha deeply admires Gotama but explains to him that enlightenment cannot be taught in words; each person must find it alone. Gotama warns him gently against too much cleverness, and Siddhartha leaves, feeling Gotama has taken his friend but given him himself.

Background: Gotama is Siddhartha Gautama, the historical Buddha; Hesse deliberately gives his hero the Buddha's own name.

Significance: The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are novices, discard, enticed, venerated, exhaled. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices." Webster's says: One who is new in any business, profession, or calling. Now the word history: "novice": nov (Latin novus, "new"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "discard": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + ard (Latin ardere, "to burn"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "entice": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Gotama is Siddhartha Gautama, the historical Buddha; Hesse deliberately gives his hero the Buddha's own name. Why does this chapter matter? The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted. Write down one question you want answered.*

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see characterization, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the teacher and the teaching.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Characterization, Theme, Conflict.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *The Buddha went on his way, modestly and deep in his thoughts, his calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly. With a hidden smile, quiet, calm, somewhat resembling a healthy child, the Buddha walked, wore the robe and placed his feet just as all of his monks did, according to a precise rule. But his face and his walk, his quietly lowered glance, his quietly dangling hand and even every finger of his quietly dangling hand expressed peace, expressed perfection, did not search, did not imitate, breathed softly in an unwithering calm, in an unwithering light, an untouchable peace.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Theme, Conflict: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Gotama," how does Hesse show the teacher and the teaching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the teacher and the teaching, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the teacher and the teaching. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
novices	One who is new in any business, profession, or calling	*Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices.*	"novice": nov (Latin novus, "new"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
discard	(Card Playing) To throw out of one's hand, as superfluous cards	*There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them.*	"discard": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + ard (Latin ardere, "to burn"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
enticed	To draw on, by exciting hope or desire	*No teachings will entice me any more, since this man's teachings have not enticed me.*	"entice": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
venerated	To regard with reverential respect	*Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one.*	"venerate": ven (Latin venire, "to come") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
exhaled	To breathe out	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	"exhale": ex- (Latin ex, "out of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
glistened	To sparkle or shine	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	"glisten": ten (Latin tenere, "to hold"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
openness	The quality or state of being open	*With half of a smile, with an unwavering openness and kindness, Gotama looked into the stranger's eyes and bid him to leave with a hardly noticeable gesture.*	"openness": -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
equanimity	Evenness of mind	*The Buddha's eyes quietly looked to the ground; quietly, in perfect equanimity his inscrutable face was smiling.*	"equanimity": anim (Latin anima, "breath, soul") + -ity (Latin -itas, "quality of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
dangling			

	To hang loosely, or with a swinging or jerking motion	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	"dangle": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
renounced	To declare against	*You have renounced your home and your parents, renounced your birth and possessions, renounced your free will, renounced all friendship.*	"renounce": re- (Latin re-, "back, again"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the unity of all things?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. Where do they hear Gotama teach?
   A. In a palace
   B. In the grove of Jetavana
   C. In a city market
   D. By the river
2. What does Govinda decide?
   A. To follow Siddhartha
   B. To return home
   C. To become a merchant
   D. To join Gotama's followers
3. What does Siddhartha tell Gotama?
   A. He wants to be a monk
   B. His teachings are false
   C. He will return later
   D. Enlightenment cannot be taught in words
4. What does Gotama warn Siddhartha about?
   A. Loving too much
   B. Being lazy
   C. Being too clever

D. Being too poor

5. What does Siddhartha feel Gotama gave him?
   A. A mantra
   B. A robe
   C. Himself
   D. A begging bowl
6. In the line “Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices.”, what does “novices” most nearly mean?
   A. (Card Playing) To throw out of one's hand, as superfluous cards
   B. To regard with reverential respect
   C. One who is new in any business, profession, or calling
   D. To draw on, by exciting hope or desire
7. In the line “There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them.”, what does “discard” most nearly mean?
   A. (Card Playing) To throw out of one's hand, as superfluous cards
   B. To regard with reverential respect
   C. One who is new in any business, profession, or calling
   D. To draw on, by exciting hope or desire

Answer key: 1. B (In the grove of Jetavana); 2. D (To join Gotama's followers); 3. D (Enlightenment cannot be taught in words); 4. C (Being too clever); 5. C (Himself); 6. C (One who is new in any business, profession, or calling); 7. A ((Card Playing) To throw out of one's hand, as superfluous cards)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Gotama,” how does Hesse show the teacher and the teaching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Gotama develops the idea of the teacher and the teaching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in Gotama to complicate the reader's understanding of the teacher and the teaching. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Gotama within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the teacher and the teaching responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Gotama as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the teacher and the teaching. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *No teachings will entice me any more, since this man's teachings have not enticed me.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "enticed" most nearly mean?

   A. Evenness of mind

   B. To draw on, by exciting hope or desire

   C. To hang loosely, or with a swinging or jerking motion

   D. To declare against

2. *The Buddha went on his way, modestly and deep in his thoughts, his calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly. With a hidden smile, quiet, calm, somewhat resembling a healthy child, the Buddha walked, wore the robe and placed his feet just as all of his monks did, according to a precise rule. But his face and his walk, his quietly lowered glance, his quietly dangling hand and even every finger of his quietly dangling hand expressed peace, expressed perfection, did not search, did not imitate, breathed softly in an unwithering calm, in an unwithering light, an untouchable peace.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Gotama"?

   A. The teacher and the teaching

   B. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   C. Farewells at Hunsford

   D. Family uproar

SAT key: 1. B (To draw on, by exciting hope or desire); 2. A (The teacher and the teaching)

Lesson 4: Awakening

Focus: awakening to the world

Teacher only · spoilers

Walking away, Siddhartha realizes he has always fled from himself and resolves to learn from himself. Suddenly the world appears new and beautiful—colors, rivers, forests—no longer illusion but reality to be experienced. He feels a chill of loneliness: he is no longer a Brahmin or a Samana, but he will not go home.

Background: In Hindu thought, Maya is the veil of illusion over the world; Siddhartha turns away from seeing the world as Maya.

Significance: This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are dissect, inhaled, deceptions, heading, teachings. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part." Webster's says: (Anat.) To divide into separate parts. Now the word history: "dissect": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "inhale": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "deception": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -tion (Latin -tio, "the act of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. In Hindu thought, Maya is the veil of illusion over the world; Siddhartha turns away from seeing the world as Maya. Why does this chapter matter? This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for imagery.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see imagery, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to awakening to the world.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Imagery, Symbolism, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of imagery. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him. He pondered about this sensation, which filled him completely, as he was slowly walking along. He pondered deeply, like diving into a deep water he let himself sink down to the ground of the sensation, down to the place where the causes lie, because to identify the causes, so it seemed to him, is the very essence of thinking, and by this alone sensations turn into realizations and are not lost, but become entities and start to emit like rays of light what is inside of them.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Imagery, Symbolism, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Awakening," how does Hesse show awakening to the world? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about awakening to the world, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes awakening to the world. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
dissect	(Anat.) To divide into separate parts	*I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels*	"dissect": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part.	
inhaled	To breathe or draw into the lungs	*Deeply, he inhaled, and for a moment, he felt cold and shivered.*	“inhale”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
deceptions	The act of deceiving or misleading	*“When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	“deception”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -tion (Latin -tio, "the act of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
heading	The act or state of one who, or that which, heads	*And it was not long until he walked again in long strides, started to proceed swiftly and impatiently, heading no longer for home, no longer to his father, no longer back.*	“heading”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
teachings	The act or business of instructing	*He had also left the last teacher who had appeared on his path, even him, the highest and wisest teacher, the most holy one, Buddha, he had left him, had to part with him, was not able to accept his teachings.*	“teaching”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
strides	To walk with long steps, especially in a measured or pompous manner	*And it was not long until he walked again in long strides, started to proceed swiftly and impatiently, heading no longer for home, no longer to his father, no longer back.*	“stride”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
workers	One who, or that which, works	*There was no nobleman who did not belong to the noblemen, no worker that did not belong to the workers, and found refuge with them, shared their life, spoke their language.*	“worker”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
perfected	Brought to consummation or completeness	*When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him.*	“perfect”: per- (Latin per, "through, thoroughly") + fect (Latin facere, "to make"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
symbols	A visible sign or representation of an idea	*“When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	“symbol”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
coincidence			

	The condition of occupying the same place in space	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	"coincidence": -ence (Latin -entia, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter?
2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the river and time?

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Siddhartha resolve to learn from?
   A. The Samanas
   B. The Buddha
   C. Himself
   D. His father
2. How does the world appear to him?
   A. Unreal
   B. Frightening
   C. New and beautiful
   D. Grey and dull
3. What does he feel after the awakening?
   A. Hunger
   B. Anger
   C. A cold loneliness
   D. Pride in his caste
4. Does Siddhartha go home to his father?
   A. No, he moves forward alone
   B. Yes, at once
   C. Yes, to say goodbye
   D. He sends a letter
5. What idea does he reject here?
   A. Learning from nature

B. Being alone

C. Seeing the world as mere illusion

D. Self-knowledge

6. In the line “I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part.”, what does “dissect” most nearly mean?

   A. (Anat.) To divide into separate parts

   B. The act of deceiving or misleading

   C. To breathe or draw into the lungs

   D. The act or state of one who, or that which, heads

7. In the line “Deeply, he inhaled, and for a moment, he felt cold and shivered.”, what does “inhaled” most nearly mean?

   A. (Anat.) To divide into separate parts

   B. The act of deceiving or misleading

   C. The act or state of one who, or that which, heads

   D. To breathe or draw into the lungs

Answer key: 1. C (Himself); 2. C (New and beautiful); 3. C (A cold loneliness); 4. A (No, he moves forward alone); 5. C (Seeing the world as mere illusion); 6. A ((Anat.) To divide into separate parts); 7. D (To breathe or draw into the lungs)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.4, W.7.1): In “Awakening,” how does Hesse show awakening to the world? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Awakening develops the idea of awakening to the world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses imagery in Awakening to complicate the reader's understanding of awakening to the world. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Awakening within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of awakening to the world responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Awakening as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of awakening to the world. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account

for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "deceptions" most nearly mean?

   A. A visible sign or representation of an idea
   B. Brought to consummation or completeness
   C. The condition of occupying the same place in space
   D. The act of deceiving or misleading

2. *When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him. He pondered about this sensation, which filled him completely, as he was slowly walking along. He pondered deeply, like diving into a deep water he let himself sink down to the ground of the sensation, down to the place where the causes lie, because to identify the causes, so it seemed to him, is the very essence of thinking, and by this alone sensations turn into realizations and are not lost, but become entities and start to emit like rays of light what is inside of them.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Awakening"?

   A. An unhappy marriage observed
   B. Awakening to the world
   C. Isolation in the north
   D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

SAT key: 1. D (The act of deceiving or misleading); 2. B (Awakening to the world)

Lesson 5: Kamala

Focus: entering the city and learning love

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha dreams of Govinda becoming a woman, crosses a river with a kind ferryman (Vasudeva) who predicts his return, and reaches a city where he sees the beautiful courtesan Kamala. She tells him he needs fine clothes, shoes and money; he learns quickly and, through her, gains a position with the merchant Kamaswami. Kamala becomes his teacher in love.

Background: Courtesans in ancient India could be educated, wealthy and respected.

Significance: The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are disembarking, seashells, sexuality, shimmered, pouches. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: ""I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river." Webster's says: To remove from on board a vessel. Now the word history: "disembark": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + bark (Late Latin barca, "small boat"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "seashell": se- (Latin se-, "apart"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "sexuality": se- (Latin se-, "apart") + -ity (Latin -itas, "quality of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Courtesans in ancient India could be educated, wealthy and respected. Why does this chapter matter? The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see characterization, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to entering the city and learning love.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Characterization, Symbolism, Setting.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river. "I have no gift I could give you for your hospitality, my dear, and also no payment for your work. I am a man without a home, a son of a Brahmin and a Samana."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Symbolism, Setting: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Kamala," how does Hesse show entering the city and learning love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about entering the city and learning love, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes entering the city and learning love. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
disembarking	To remove from on board a vessel	*"I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.*	"disembark": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + bark (Late Latin barca, "small boat"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

seashells	The shell of any marine mollusk	*In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.*	"seashell": se- (Latin se-, "apart"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
sexuality	The quality or state of being distinguished by sex	*Siddhartha also felt desire and felt the source of his sexuality moving; but since he had never touched a woman before, he hesitated for a moment, while his hands were already prepared to reach out for her.*	"sexuality": se- (Latin se-, "apart") + -ity (Latin -itas, "quality of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
shimmered	To shine with a tremulous or intermittent light	*It intoxicated him and rendered him unconscious.—When Siddhartha woke up, the pale river shimmered through the door of the hut, and in the forest, a dark call of an owl resounded deeply and pleasantly.*	"shimmer": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
pouches	A small bag	*Many young men come to me, and there are also sons of Brahmins among them, but they come in beautiful clothes, they come in fine shoes, they have perfume in their hair and money in their pouches.*	"pouch": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
cistern	An artificial reservoir or tank for holding water, beer, or other liquids	*Differently the sun burnt the head, differently the shade of the forest cooled him down, differently the stream and the cistern, the pumpkin and the banana tasted.*	"cistern": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
rainbows	A bow or arch exhibiting, in concentric bands, the several colors of the spectrum, and formed in the part of the…	*He saw trees, stars, animals, clouds, rainbows, rocks, herbs, flowers, stream and river, the glistening dew in the bushes in the morning, distant high mountains which were blue and pale, birds sang and bees, wind silverishly blew through the rice field.*	"rainbow": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
initiate	To introduce by a first act	*While talking, she put her left foot on his right one and made a movement as a woman does who would want to initiate that kind of sexual pleasure with a man, which the textbooks call "climbing a tree."*	"initiate": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
clanged	To strike together so as to produce a ringing metallic sound	*Kamala loudly clapped her hands, so that the golden bracelets clanged.*	"clang": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

jackals	(Zoöl.) Any one of several species of carnivorous animals inhabiting Africa and Asia, related to the dog and wolf	*"Why should I be afraid of a Samana, a stupid Samana from the forest, who is coming from the jackals and doesn't even know yet what women are?"*	"jackal": -al (Latin -alis, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with love and attachment?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Who ferries Siddhartha across the river?
   A. Kamaswami
   B. Gotama
   C. Vasudeva
   D. Govinda
2. What does the ferryman predict?
   A. He will be rich
   B. Siddhartha will return
   C. He will die young
   D. He will become a monk
3. Who is Kamala?
   A. Siddhartha's sister
   B. A beautiful courtesan
   C. A Samana
   D. A merchant's wife
4. What three skills does Siddhartha name?
   A. Reading, writing and singing
   B. Trading, cooking and building
   C. Thinking, waiting and fasting
   D. Fighting, riding and hunting
5. Who gives Siddhartha work?
   A. His father

B. Vasudeva

C. Govinda

D. The merchant Kamaswami

6. In the line ““I thank you, my benefactor,” spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.”, what does “disembarking” most nearly mean?

A. To remove from on board a vessel

B. The shell of any marine mollusk

C. To shine with a tremulous or intermittent light

D. The quality or state of being distinguished by sex

7. In the line “In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.”, what does “seashells” most nearly mean?

A. To remove from on board a vessel

B. To shine with a tremulous or intermittent light

C. The quality or state of being distinguished by sex

D. The shell of any marine mollusk

Answer key: 1. C (Vasudeva); 2. B (Siddhartha will return); 3. B (A beautiful courtesan); 4. C (Thinking, waiting and fasting); 5. D (The merchant Kamaswami); 6. A (To remove from on board a vessel); 7. D (The shell of any marine mollusk)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Kamala,” how does Hesse show entering the city and learning love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Kamala develops the idea of entering the city and learning love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in Kamala to complicate the reader's understanding of entering the city and learning love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Kamala within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of entering the city and learning love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Kamala as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of entering the city and learning love. Position your reading within a named

critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Siddhartha also felt desire and felt the source of his sexuality moving; but since he had never touched a woman before, he hesitated for a moment, while his hands were already prepared to reach out for her.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "sexuality" most nearly mean?

   A. To introduce by a first act

   B. (Zoöl.) Any one of several species of carnivorous animals inhabiting Africa and Asia, related to the dog and wolf

   C. To strike together so as to produce a ringing metallic sound

   D. The quality or state of being distinguished by sex

2. *"I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river. "I have no gift I could give you for your hospitality, my dear, and also no payment for your work. I am a man without a home, a son of a Brahmin and a Samana."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Kamala"?

   A. Bingley returns

   B. Entering the city and learning love

   C. Self-recognition

   D. Loss and vengeance

SAT key: 1. D (The quality or state of being distinguished by sex); 2. B (Entering the city and learning love)

Lesson 6: With the Childlike People

Focus: detachment among the childlike people

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha works for Kamaswami but treats business as a game, caring little for profit, which irritates the merchant yet makes Siddhartha successful. He watches ordinary people—the 'childlike people'—with amusement as they suffer over money and desire. Kamala teaches him the art of love, and they agree that neither of them can truly love.

Background: Hesse contrasts spiritual detachment with worldly attachment, echoing Buddhist teaching on desire.

Significance: Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are businesses, storage, bananas, hastiness, besiege. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "Besides from this, Siddhartha's interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon." Webster's says: That which busies one, or that which engages the time, attention, or labor of any one, as his principal concern or.... Now the word history: "business": -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "storage": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "banana": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Hesse contrasts spiritual detachment with worldly attachment, echoing Buddhist teaching on desire. Why does this chapter matter? Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see characterization, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to detachment among the childlike people.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Characterization, Irony, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"It is very good, sir. When a person has nothing to eat, fasting is the smartest thing he could do. When, for example, Siddhartha hadn't learned to fast, he would have to accept any kind of service before that day is up, whether it may be with you or wherever, because hunger would force him to do so. But like this, Siddhartha can wait calmly, he knows no impatience, he knows no emergency, for a long time he can allow hunger to besiege him and can laugh about it. This, sir, is what fasting is good for."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Irony, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "With the Childlike People," how does Hesse show detachment among the childlike people? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about detachment among the childlike people, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes detachment among the childlike people. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
businesses	That which busies one, or that which engages the time, attention, or labor of any one, as his principal concern or…	*Besides from this, Siddhartha's interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon.*	"business": -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
storage	The act of depositing in a store or warehouse for safe keeping	*Kamaswami told him about his trade, showed him the merchandise and storage rooms, showed him calculations.*	"storage": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
bananas	A perennial herbaceous plant of almost treelike size (Musa sapientum)	*He did not treat the rich foreign merchant any different than the servant who shaved him and the street-vendor whom he let cheat him out of some small change when buying bananas.*	"banana": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
hastiness	The quality or state of being hasty	*But like this, I've had a few good days, I've learned, had joy, I've neither harmed myself nor others by annoyance and hastiness.*	"hastiness": -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
besiege	To beset or surround with armed forces, for the purpose of compelling to surrender	*But like this, Siddhartha can wait calmly, he knows no impatience, he knows no emergency, for a long time he can allow hunger to besiege him and can laugh about it.*	"besiege": be- (Old English be-, "thoroughly, about"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
tumbles	To roll over, or to and fro	*Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground.*	"tumble": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
courtesan	A woman who prostitutes herself for hire	*The courtesan bent over him, took a long look at his face, at his eyes, which had grown tired.*	"courtesan": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
flexible	Capable of being flexed or bent	*Her body was flexible like that of a jaguar and like the bow of a hunter; he who had learned*	"flexible": -ible (Latin -ibilis, "able to be"). Root

		from her how to make love, was knowledgeable of many forms of lust, many secrets.	not in our table: have students find it.
admonished	To warn or notify of a fault	*At times he felt, deep in his chest, a dying, quiet voice, which admonished him quietly, lamented quietly; he hardly perceived it.*	“admonish”: ad- (Latin ad, "to, toward"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
shipping	Relating to ships, their ownership, transfer, or employment	*He soon saw that Siddhartha knew little about rice and wool, shipping and trade, but that he acted in a fortunate manner, and that Siddhartha surpassed him, the merchant, in calmness and equanimity, and in the art of listening and deeply understanding previously unknown people.*	“shipping”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. How does Siddhartha treat business?
   A. As a game he does not take seriously
   B. As sacred work
   C. As a burden he hates
   D. As a way to help the poor
2. What does he call ordinary people?
   A. The childlike people
   B. The fallen ones
   C. The masters
   D. The sleepers
3. How does Kamaswami feel about Siddhartha's attitude?
   A. Irritated but impressed by results
   B. Delighted
   C. Afraid
   D. Indifferent

4. What do Siddhartha and Kamala agree about?
   A. Neither can truly love
   B. They should become Samanas
   C. They will leave the city
   D. They will marry
5. What is ironic about his view of others?
   A. He is poorer than them
   B. He is slowly becoming like them
   C. He is their king
   D. He does not see them
6. In the line "Besides from this, Siddhartha's interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon.", what does "businesses" most nearly mean?
   A. That which busies one, or that which engages the time, attention, or labor of any one, as his principal concern or…
   B. A perennial herbaceous plant of almost treelike size (Musa sapientum)
   C. The act of depositing in a store or warehouse for safe keeping
   D. The quality or state of being hasty
7. In the line "Kamaswami told him about his trade, showed him the merchandise and storage rooms, showed him calculations.", what does "storage" most nearly mean?
   A. That which busies one, or that which engages the time, attention, or labor of any one, as his principal concern or…
   B. A perennial herbaceous plant of almost treelike size (Musa sapientum)
   C. The act of depositing in a store or warehouse for safe keeping
   D. The quality or state of being hasty

Answer key: 1. A (As a game he does not take seriously); 2. A (The childlike people); 3. A (Irritated but impressed by results); 4. A (Neither can truly love); 5. B (He is slowly becoming like them); 6. A (That which busies one, or that which engages the time, attention, or labor of any one, as his principal concern or…); 7. C (The act of depositing in a store or warehouse for safe keeping)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In "With the Childlike People," how does Hesse show detachment among the childlike people? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how With the Childlike People develops the idea of detachment among the childlike people. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in With the Childlike People to complicate the reader's understanding of detachment among the childlike people. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate With the Childlike People within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of detachment among the childlike people responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads With the Childlike People as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of detachment among the childlike people. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *He did not treat the rich foreign merchant any different than the servant who shaved him and the street-vendor whom he let cheat him out of some small change when buying bananas.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “bananas” most nearly mean?

   A. To warn or notify of a fault

   B. Capable of being flexed or bent

   C. Relating to ships, their ownership, transfer, or employment

   D. A perennial herbaceous plant of almost treelike size (Musa sapientum)

2. *“It is very good, sir. When a person has nothing to eat, fasting is the smartest thing he could do. When, for example, Siddhartha hadn’t learned to fast, he would have to accept any kind of service before that day is up, whether it may be with you or wherever, because hunger would force him to do so. But like this, Siddhartha can wait calmly, he knows no impatience, he knows no emergency, for a long time he can allow hunger to besiege him and can laugh about it. This, sir, is what fasting is good for.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “With the Childlike People”?

   A. Loss and leaving home

   B. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

   C. Trusted relatives

   D. Detachment among the childlike people

SAT key: 1. D (A perennial herbaceous plant of almost treelike size (Musa sapientum)); 2. D (Detachment among the childlike people)

Lesson 7: Sansara

Focus: the cycle of desire

Teacher only · spoilers

Over many years Siddhartha grows wealthy, gambles, drinks, and becomes greedy and weary—like the childlike people. Kamala tells him she wishes to learn about Gotama. After a dream of Kamala's songbird lying dead in its golden cage, Siddhartha feels disgust at his life and leaves the city without a word. Kamala, pregnant with his child, frees her bird.

Background: Samsara (spelled 'Sansara' in this translation) is the cycle of birth, suffering and rebirth.

Significance: The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What does the dead songbird symbolize? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are gambled, castaway, demonstrating, mockingly, devious. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again." Webster's says: To play or game for money or other stake. Now the word history: "gamble": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "castaway": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "demonstrate": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Samsara (spelled 'Sansara' in this translation) is the cycle of birth, suffering and rebirth. Why does this chapter matter? The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for symbolism.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see symbolism, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the cycle of desire.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Symbolism, Theme, Tone / mood.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of symbolism. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness. Worthless, so it seemed to him, worthless and pointless was the way he had been going through life; nothing which was alive, nothing which was in some way delicious or worth keeping he had left in his hands. Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Symbolism, Theme, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Sansara," how does Hesse show the cycle of desire? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the cycle of desire, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes the cycle of desire. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
gambled	To play or game for money or other stake	*Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again.*	"gamble": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

castaway	One who, or that which, is cast away or shipwrecked	*Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*	"castaway": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
demonstrating	To point out	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	"demonstrate": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
mockingly	By way of derision	*He played the game due to a pain of his heart, losing and wasting his wretched money in the game brought him an angry joy, in no other way he could demonstrate his disdain for wealth, the merchants' false god, more clearly and more mockingly.*	"mockingly": -ly (Old English -lice, "in the manner of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
devious	Out of a straight line	*On a strange and devious way, Siddhartha had gotten into this final and most base of all dependencies, by means of the game of dice.*	"devious": de- (Latin de, "down from, away"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
zealously	Filled with, or characterized by, zeal	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	"zealous": -ous (Latin -osus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
debtors	One who owes a debt	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	"debtor": de- (Latin de, "down from, away"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
reliable	Suitable or fit to be relied on	*He only noticed that this bright and reliable voice inside of him, which had awoken in him at that time and had ever guided him in his best times, had become silent.*	"reliable": re- (Latin re-, "back, again"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
encompassed		*Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness.*	"encompass": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into") + pass

	To circumscribe or go round so as to surround closely		(Latin passus, "step"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
poultry	Domestic fowls reared for the table, or for their eggs or feathers, such as cocks and hens, capons, turkeys, ducks,…	*He had learned to eat tenderly and carefully prepared food, even fish, even meat and poultry, spices and sweets, and to drink wine, which causes sloth and forgetfulness.*	“poultry”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

Discussion questions

1. What does the dead songbird symbolize?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What happens to Siddhartha over the years in the city?
   A. He becomes poor
   B. He becomes greedy and weary
   C. He becomes a ferryman
   D. He becomes a holy man
2. What does Siddhartha dream about?
   A. His father's house
   B. Govinda dying
   C. Kamala's songbird dead in its cage
   D. A river in flood
3. How does Siddhartha leave the city?
   A. Suddenly, without a word
   B. On a ship
   C. With a farewell feast
   D. With Kamala
4. What does Kamala do after he leaves?
   A. Burns her garden
   B. Marries Kamaswami
   C. Frees her songbird

D. Follows him

5. What is Sansara?
   A. A river
   B. A city
   C. The cycle of suffering and rebirth
   D. A song
6. In the line “Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again.”, what does “gambled” most nearly mean?
   A. One who, or that which, is cast away or shipwrecked
   B. To play or game for money or other stake
   C. By way of derision
   D. To point out
7. In the line “Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.”, what does “castaway” most nearly mean?
   A. By way of derision
   B. One who, or that which, is cast away or shipwrecked
   C. To play or game for money or other stake
   D. To point out

Answer key: 1. B (He becomes greedy and weary); 2. C (Kamala's songbird dead in its cage); 3. A (Suddenly, without a word); 4. C (Frees her songbird); 5. C (The cycle of suffering and rebirth); 6. B (To play or game for money or other stake); 7. B (One who, or that which, is cast away or shipwrecked)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.4, W.7.1): In “Sansara,” how does Hesse show the cycle of desire? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Sansara develops the idea of the cycle of desire. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in Sansara to complicate the reader's understanding of the cycle of desire. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Sansara within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the cycle of desire responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Sansara as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the cycle of desire. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “demonstrating” most nearly mean?

   A. To point out

   B. Suitable or fit to be relied on

   C. To circumscribe or go round so as to surround closely

   D. Domestic fowls reared for the table, or for their eggs or feathers, such as cocks and hens, capons, turkeys, ducks,…

2. *Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness. Worthless, so it seemed to him, worthless and pointless was the way he had been going through life; nothing which was alive, nothing which was in some way delicious or worth keeping he had left in his hands. Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Sansara”?

   A. Injustice and the burden of silence

   B. Confiding and consent

   C. Visit to Hunsford

   D. The cycle of desire

SAT key: 1. A (To point out); 2. D (The cycle of desire)

Lesson 8: By the River

Focus: despair and renewal by the river

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha reaches the river and, sick of himself, leans to drown. From deep within comes the sacred word Om, and he falls into a deep sleep under a coconut tree. He wakes renewed; Govinda, now a monk, has watched over him without recognizing him. Siddhartha reflects that he had to experience despair to learn its emptiness, and decides to stay by the river.

Background: Om is the sacred syllable in Hindu and Buddhist traditions, representing ultimate reality.

Significance: Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are rejuvenated, ointments, unlearn, sobering, vomiting. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!” Webster's says: Rendered young again. Now the word history: “rejuvenated”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + ven (Latin venire, "to come") + -ed (Old English -ed, past or "having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. “ointment”: -ment (Latin -mentum, "result or means of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “unlearn”: un- (Old English un-, "not"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Om is the sacred syllable in Hindu and Buddhist traditions, representing ultimate reality. Why does this chapter matter? Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for symbolism.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see symbolism, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to despair and renewal by the river.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Symbolism, Imagery, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of symbolism. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Siddhartha was deeply shocked. So this was how things were with him, so doomed was he, so much he had lost his way and was forsaken by all knowledge, that he had been able to seek death, that this wish, this wish of a child, had been able to grow in him: to find rest by annihilating his body! What all agony of these recent times, all sobering realizations, all desperation had not brought about, this was brought on by this moment, when the Om entered his consciousness: he became aware of himself in his misery and in his error.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Symbolism, Imagery, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "By the River," how does Hesse show despair and renewal by the river? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about despair and renewal by the river, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes despair and renewal by the river. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
rejuvenated	Rendered young again	*Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!*	"rejuvenated": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + ven (Latin venire, "to come") + -ed (Old English -ed, past or "having"). Teacher note from a

			root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
ointments	That which serves to anoint	*There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth.*	"ointment": -ment (Latin -mentum, "result or means of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
unlearn	To forget, as what has been learned	*I had to spend many years losing my spirit, to unlearn thinking again, to forget the oneness.*	"unlearn": un- (Old English un-, "not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
sobering	Temperate in the use of spirituous liquors	*What all agony of these recent times, all sobering realizations, all desperation had not brought about, this was brought on by this moment, when the Om entered his consciousness: he became aware of himself in his misery and in his error.*	"sober": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
vomiting	The spasmodic ejection of matter from the stomach through the mouth	*This was the great vomiting he had longed for: death, the smashing to bits of the form he hated!*	"vomiting": mit (Latin mittere, "to send") + -ing (Old English -ing, action). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
penitents	Feeling pain or sorrow on account of sins or offenses	*But as a young man, I followed the penitents, lived in the forest, suffered of heat and frost, learned to hunger, taught my body to become dead.*	"penitent": -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
smashing	To break in pieces by violence	*This was the great vomiting he had longed for: death, the smashing to bits of the form he hated!*	"smash": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
wrestled	To contend, by grappling with, and striving to trip or throw down, an opponent	*Was this not his self, his small, frightened, and proud self, he had wrestled with for so many years, which had defeated him again and again, which was back again after every killing, prohibited joy, felt fear?*	"wrestle": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
lustful	Full of lust	*I'm wearing them, because I have been a rich man, and I'm wearing my hair like the worldly and lustful people, for I have been one of them."*	"lustful": -ful (Old English -full, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
annihilate	To reduce to nothing or nonexistence	*There was nothing left for him, except to annihilate himself, except to smash the failure into which he had shaped his life, to throw it away, before the feet of mockingly laughing gods.*	"annihilate": -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the unity of all things?

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Siddhartha intend to do at the river?
   A. Bathe
   B. Fish
   C. Drown himself
   D. Cross it
2. What stops him?
   A. A storm
   B. A shout from Govinda
   C. A child
   D. The word Om rising within
3. Who watches over him while he sleeps?
   A. Kamaswami
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Govinda
   D. Kamala
4. Does Govinda recognize him at first?
   A. Yes immediately
   B. Only by his clothes
   C. No
   D. Only by voice
5. What does Siddhartha decide?
   A. To join the monks
   B. To go home
   C. To stay by the river
   D. To return to the city
6. In the line “Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!”, what does “rejuvenated” most nearly mean?
   A. Rendered young again

B. That which serves to anoint

C. To forget, as what has been learned

D. Temperate in the use of spirituous liquors

7. In the line “There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth.”, what does “ointments” most nearly mean?

A. To forget, as what has been learned

B. That which serves to anoint

C. Rendered young again

D. Temperate in the use of spirituous liquors

Answer key: 1. C (Drown himself); 2. D (The word Om rising within); 3. C (Govinda); 4. C (No); 5. C (To stay by the river); 6. A (Rendered young again); 7. B (That which serves to anoint)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.4, W.7.1): In “By the River,” how does Hesse show despair and renewal by the river? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how By the River develops the idea of despair and renewal by the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in By the River to complicate the reader's understanding of despair and renewal by the river. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate By the River within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of despair and renewal by the river responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads By the River as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of despair and renewal by the river. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had to spend many years losing my spirit, to unlearn thinking again, to forget the oneness.*

As used in the text, what does the word “unlearn” most nearly mean?

A. Full of lust

B. To reduce to nothing or nonexistence

C. To forget, as what has been learned

D. To contend, by grappling with, and striving to trip or throw down, an opponent

2. *Siddhartha was deeply shocked. So this was how things were with him, so doomed was he, so much he had lost his way and was forsaken by all knowledge, that he had been able to seek death, that this wish, this wish of a child, had been able to grow in him: to find rest by annihilating his body! What all agony of these recent times, all sobering realizations, all desperation had not brought about, this was brought on by this moment, when the Om entered his consciousness: he became aware of himself in his misery and in his error.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "By the River"?

A. An imperious hostess

B. Disappointment and philosophy

C. Despair and renewal by the river

D. The wedding night and its catastrophe

SAT key: 1. C (To forget, as what has been learned); 2. C (Despair and renewal by the river)

Lesson 9: The Ferryman

Focus: learning from the river

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha becomes Vasudeva's assistant. Vasudeva, a simple and attentive listener, teaches him to listen to the river, which shows that there is no such thing as time—the river is everywhere at once. Years pass peacefully. Gotama's monks pass by, carrying news that the Buddha is dying, and Kamala travels with her son to see him; she is bitten by a snake, recognizes Siddhartha at the ferry, and dies in his arms. Siddhartha keeps their son.

Background: The image of the river echoes ancient ideas, such as Heraclitus's saying that one cannot step into the same river twice.

Significance: The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What does the river teach that no person could? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are obstructing, precocious, ferried, oarsman, wondrously. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman's job was to get them quickly across that obstacle." Webster's says: To block up. Now the word history: "obstruct": ob- (Latin ob, "against, toward") + struct (Latin struere, "to build"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "precocious": pre- (Latin prae, "before") + -ious (Latin -iosus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "ferry": fer (Latin ferre, "to carry, bear"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. The image of the river echoes ancient ideas, such as Heraclitus's saying that one cannot step into the same river twice. Why does this chapter matter? The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for symbolism.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see symbolism, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to learning from the river.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Symbolism, Characterization, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of symbolism. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"Now I recognise you," he finally said. "At one time, you've slept in my hut, this was a long time ago, possibly more than twenty years ago, and you've been ferried across the river by me, and we parted like good friends. Haven't you been a Samana? I can't think of your name any more."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Symbolism, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "The Ferryman," how does Hesse show learning from the river? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about learning from the river, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes learning from the river. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
obstructing	To block up		

		They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman's job was to get them quickly across that obstacle.	"obstruct": ob- (Latin ob, "against, toward") + struct (Latin struere, "to build"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
precocious	Ripe or mature before the proper or natural time	*They had been, so it seemed to him, proud and precocious words; with a smile, he remembered them.*	"precocious": pre- (Latin prae, "before") + -ious (Latin -iosus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
ferried	To carry or transport over a river, strait, or other narrow water, in a boat	*Behold, once before you have ferried me across this water in your boat for the immaterial reward of a good deed.*	"ferry": fer (Latin ferre, "to carry, bear"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
oarsman	One who uses, or is skilled in the use of, an oar	*The rich and elegant Siddhartha is becoming an oarsman's servant, the learned Brahmin Siddhartha becomes a ferryman: this has also been told to you by the river.*	"oarsman": man (Latin manus, "hand"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
wondrously	In a wonderful or surprising manner or degree	*He looked up and first saw the boy's face, which wondrously reminded him of something, like a warning to remember something he had forgotten.*	"wondrous": -ous (Latin -osus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
birthplace	The town, city, or country, where a person is born	*Listening carefully, he let everything enter his mind, birthplace and childhood, all that learning, all that searching, all joy, all distress.*	"birthplace": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
singsong	Bad singing or poetry	*And with that singsong, the boy became calm, was only now and then uttering a sob and fell asleep.*	"singsong": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
collapsed	To fall together suddenly, as the sides of a hollow vessel	*Hurriedly, they now both ran along the path, in order to reach people, and got near to the ferry, there Kamala collapsed, and was not able to go any further.*	"collapse": col- (Latin com-, "with"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
oneness	The state of being one	*A lot it has told me, deeply it has filled me with the healing thought, with the thought of oneness."*	"oneness": -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
chewing	To bite and grind with the teeth	*She, Kamala herself, had also become tired, and while the boy was chewing a banana, she crouched down on the ground, closed her eyes a bit, and rested.*	"chew": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

Discussion questions

1. What does the river teach that no person could?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the river and time?

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whose assistant does Siddhartha become?
   A. Gotama's
   B. Govinda's
   C. Kamaswami's
   D. Vasudeva's
2. What is Vasudeva's greatest skill?
   A. Preaching
   B. Fighting
   C. Listening
   D. Bargaining
3. What does the river teach about time?
   A. That time is money
   B. That time does not truly exist
   C. That time is short
   D. That time is cruel
4. How is Kamala hurt?
   A. She catches fever
   B. She is robbed
   C. She is bitten by a snake
   D. She falls in the river
5. Who stays with Siddhartha after Kamala dies?
   A. Govinda
   B. Their son
   C. Gotama
   D. Kamaswami

6. In the line “They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman’s job was to get them quickly across that obstacle.”, what does “obstructing” most nearly mean?
   A. To block up
   B. To carry or transport over a river, strait, or other narrow water, in a boat
   C. One who uses, or is skilled in the use of, an oar
   D. Ripe or mature before the proper or natural time
7. In the line “They had been, so it seemed to him, proud and precocious words; with a smile, he remembered them.”, what does “precocious” most nearly mean?
   A. One who uses, or is skilled in the use of, an oar
   B. To carry or transport over a river, strait, or other narrow water, in a boat
   C. To block up
   D. Ripe or mature before the proper or natural time

Answer key: 1. D (Vasudeva's); 2. C (Listening); 3. B (That time does not truly exist); 4. C (She is bitten by a snake); 5. B (Their son); 6. A (To block up); 7. D (Ripe or mature before the proper or natural time)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.4, W.7.1): In “The Ferryman,” how does Hesse show learning from the river? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Ferryman develops the idea of learning from the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in The Ferryman to complicate the reader's understanding of learning from the river. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate The Ferryman within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of learning from the river responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads The Ferryman as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of learning from the river. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Behold, once before you have ferried me across this water in your boat for the immaterial reward of a good deed.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "ferried" most nearly mean?

   A. To fall together suddenly, as the sides of a hollow vessel
   B. To bite and grind with the teeth
   C. The state of being one
   D. To carry or transport over a river, strait, or other narrow water, in a boat

2. *"Now I recognise you," he finally said. "At one time, you've slept in my hut, this was a long time ago, possibly more than twenty years ago, and you've been ferried across the river by me, and we parted like good friends. Haven't you been a Samana? I can't think of your name any more."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "The Ferryman"?

   A. Learning from the river
   B. A disastrous ball
   C. The first death and growing guilt
   D. The letter

SAT key: 1. D (To carry or transport over a river, strait, or other narrow water, in a boat); 2. A (Learning from the river)

Lesson 10: The Son

Focus: the pain of a father's love

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha's spoiled son, raised in wealth, despises the ferry life and his father's gentleness. Vasudeva advises letting the boy return to the world, but Siddhartha cannot let go. The son finally runs away, stealing the ferry money. Siddhartha follows to the city and stops at Kamala's old garden, realizing he must not pursue him. Vasudeva brings him home.

Background: This chapter reverses Chapter One: now Siddhartha is the father whose son leaves.

Significance: Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are fornicator, reciprocate, ranting, soiling, burdening. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "I hate you, you're not my father, even if you've ten times been my mother's fornicator!"" Webster's says: An unmarried person, male or female, who has criminal intercourse with the other sex. Now the word history: "fornicator": -or (Latin -or, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "reciprocate": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "rant": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. This chapter reverses Chapter One: now Siddhartha is the father whose son leaves. Why does this chapter matter? Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see characterization, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the pain of a father's love.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Characterization, Irony, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it. For long months, Vasudeva waited, watching, waited and said nothing. One day, when Siddhartha the younger had once again tormented his father very much with spite and an unsteadiness in his wishes and had broken both of his rice bowls, Vasudeva took in the evening his friend aside and talked to him.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Irony, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "The Son," how does Hesse show the pain of a father's love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the pain of a father's love, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the pain of a father's love. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
fornicator	An unmarried person, male or female, who has criminal intercourse with the other sex	*I hate you, you're not my father, even if you've ten times been my mother's fornicator!"*	"fornicator": -or (Latin -or, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

reciprocate	To move forward and backward alternately	*For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.*	“reciprocate”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
ranting	To rave in violent, high-sounding, or extravagant language, without dignity of thought	*“I must follow him,” said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday.*	“rant”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
soiling	To feed, as cattle or horses, in the barn or an inclosure, with fresh grass or green food cut for them, instead of…	*Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*	“soil”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
burdening	That which is borne or carried	*Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*	“burden”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
exuberant	Characterized by abundance or superabundance	*Won’t he become exuberant, won’t he lose himself to pleasure and power, won’t he repeat all of his father’s mistakes, won’t he perhaps get entirely lost in Sansara?”*	“exuberant”: ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + -ant (Latin -ans, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
thumped	The sound made by the sudden fall or blow of a heavy body, as of a hammer, or the like	*But the boy did not leave the hut, in stubborn disobedience and rage he stayed where he was, thumped on the ground with his feet, clenched his fists, and screamed in a powerful outburst his hatred and contempt into his father’s face.*	“thump”: hum (Latin humus, "earth" / homo, "human"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
humiliate	To reduce to a lower position in one's own eyes, or in the eyes of others	*Through all this, the son let him commit his foolish acts, let him court for his affection, let him humiliate himself every day by giving in to his moods.*	“humiliate”: hum (Latin humus, "earth" / homo, "human") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
warnings	Giving previous notice	*Were his father’s religious devotion, his teachers warnings, his own knowledge, his own search able to keep him safe?*	“warning”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.

enriched	To make rich with any kind of wealth	*Now he too felt, late, once in his lifetime, this strongest and strangest of all passions, suffered from it, suffered miserably, and was nevertheless in bliss, was nevertheless renewed in one respect, enriched by one thing.*	“enrich”: en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with love and attachment?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. How does the son treat Siddhartha?
   A. With love
   B. With fear
   C. With silence
   D. With contempt
2. What does Vasudeva advise?
   A. Punish him
   B. Let the boy go into the world
   C. Lock him up
   D. Send him to monks
3. What does the son steal?
   A. The ferry money
   B. Kamala's ring
   C. A boat only
   D. Food
4. Where does Siddhartha go in pursuit?
   A. To Gotama's grove
   B. To his father's house
   C. To the city and Kamala's old garden
   D. To the mountains
5. What is ironic about Siddhartha's pain?
   A. He now feels the attachment he once called childlike

B. He becomes rich

C. He is happy

D. He forgets the boy

6. In the line “I hate you, you’re not my father, even if you’ve ten times been my mother’s fornicator!””, what does “fornicator” most nearly mean?

   A. To rave in violent, high-sounding, or extravagant language, without dignity of thought

   B. To feed, as cattle or horses, in the barn or an inclosure, with fresh grass or green food cut for them, instead of…

   C. An unmarried person, male or female, who has criminal intercourse with the other sex

   D. To move forward and backward alternately

7. In the line “For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.”, what does “reciprocate” most nearly mean?

   A. To move forward and backward alternately

   B. To rave in violent, high-sounding, or extravagant language, without dignity of thought

   C. An unmarried person, male or female, who has criminal intercourse with the other sex

   D. To feed, as cattle or horses, in the barn or an inclosure, with fresh grass or green food cut for them, instead of…

Answer key: 1. D (With contempt); 2. B (Let the boy go into the world); 3. A (The ferry money); 4. C (To the city and Kamala's old garden); 5. A (He now feels the attachment he once called childlike); 6. C (An unmarried person, male or female, who has criminal intercourse with the other sex); 7. A (To move forward and backward alternately)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “The Son,” how does Hesse show the pain of a father's love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Son develops the idea of the pain of a father's love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in The Son to complicate the reader's understanding of the pain of a father's love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate The Son within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the pain of a father's love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads The Son as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the pain of a father's love. Position your reading within a named critical

conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *"I must follow him," said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "ranting" most nearly mean?

   A. To rave in violent, high-sounding, or extravagant language, without dignity of thought
   B. To make rich with any kind of wealth
   C. To reduce to a lower position in one's own eyes, or in the eyes of others
   D. Giving previous notice

2. *For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it. For long months, Vasudeva waited, watching, waited and said nothing. One day, when Siddhartha the younger had once again tormented his father very much with spite and an unsteadiness in his wishes and had broken both of his rice bowls, Vasudeva took in the evening his friend aside and talked to him.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "The Son"?

   A. Happiness for Jane
   B. The demand for a companion
   C. The pain of a father's love
   D. Farewells at Hunsford

SAT key: 1. A (To rave in violent, high-sounding, or extravagant language, without dignity of thought); 2. C (The pain of a father's love)

Lesson 11: Om

Focus: hearing the many voices

Teacher only · spoilers

Still aching for his son, Siddhartha sees his reflection resemble his own father and understands the circle of suffering. He confesses everything to Vasudeva, who leads him to listen; the river's voices—joy and sorrow, good and evil—blend into one word, Om. Siddhartha achieves serenity. Vasudeva, his work done, walks into the forest to die.

Background: Hesse blends Hindu and Buddhist ideas of unity with Western mysticism.

Significance: The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are blossomed, fateful, ferryboat, ripened, embarrassing. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was." Webster's says: The flower of a plant, or the essential organs of reproduction, with their appendages. Now the word history: "blossom": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "fateful": -ful (Old English -full, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "ferryboat": fer (Latin ferre, "to carry, bear"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Hesse blends Hindu and Buddhist ideas of unity with Western mysticism. Why does this chapter matter? The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for symbolism.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see symbolism, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to hearing the many voices.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Symbolism, Imagery, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of symbolism. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was. It was nothing but a readiness of the soul, an ability, a secret art, to think every moment, while living his life, the thought of oneness, to be able to feel and inhale the oneness. Slowly this blossomed in him, was shining back at him from Vasudeva's old, childlike face: harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Symbolism, Imagery, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Om," how does Hesse show hearing the many voices? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about hearing the many voices, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes hearing the many voices. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
blossomed	The flower of a plant, or the essential organs of reproduction, with their appendages	*Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.*	"blossom": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and

			record the language of origin.
fateful	Having the power of serving or accomplishing fate	*Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?*	“fateful”: -ful (Old English -full, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
ferryboat	A vessel for conveying passengers, merchandise, etc., across streams and other narrow waters	*He no longer used the ferryboat, his eyes were starting to get weak, and not just his eyes; his arms and hands as well.*	“ferryboat”: fer (Latin ferre, "to carry, bear"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
ripened	To grow ripe	*Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.*	“ripen”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
embarrassing	To hinder from freedom of thought, speech, or action by something which impedes or confuses mental action	*He reported everything, he was able to say everything, even the most embarrassing parts, everything could be said, everything shown, everything he could tell.*	“embarrass”: em- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
nurtured	The act of nourishing or nursing	*But the wound still burned, longingly and bitterly Siddhartha thought of his son, nurtured his love and tenderness in his heart, allowed the pain to gnaw at him, committed all foolish acts of love.*	“nurture”: -ure (Latin -ura, "act, result"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
runaway	One who, or that which, flees from danger, duty, restraint, etc.; a fugitive	*He presented his wound, also told how he fled today, how he ferried across the water, a childish runaway, willing to walk to the city, how the river had laughed.*	“runaway”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
resounded	To sound loudly	*It still resounded, full of suffering, searching, but other voices joined it, voices of joy and of suffering, good and bad voices, laughing and sad ones, a hundred voices, a thousand voices.*	“resound”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
bathing	Act of taking a bath or baths	*To show his wound to this listener was the same as bathing it in the river, until it had cooled and become one with the river.*	“bathing”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
weaving			

	The act of one who, or that which, weaves	*Vasudeva was sitting in the hut and weaving a basket.*	"weaving": -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whom does Siddhartha's reflection resemble?
   A. His son
   B. Govinda
   C. His father
   D. Gotama
2. Whom does he confess everything to?
   A. Vasudeva
   B. Govinda
   C. Kamala
   D. The river god
3. What do all the river's voices become?
   A. The single word Om
   B. His son's voice
   C. Silence
   D. A song of war
4. What state does Siddhartha reach?
   A. Confusion
   B. Serenity
   C. Anger
   D. Despair
5. What does Vasudeva do afterward?
   A. Leaves for the city
   B. Becomes a monk
   C. Walks into the forest to die

D. Takes a new boat

6. In the line “Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?
   A. To grow ripe
   B. A vessel for conveying passengers, merchandise, etc., across streams and other narrow waters
   C. The flower of a plant, or the essential organs of reproduction, with their appendages
   D. Having the power of serving or accomplishing fate
7. In the line “Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?”, what does “fateful” most nearly mean?
   A. To grow ripe
   B. Having the power of serving or accomplishing fate
   C. The flower of a plant, or the essential organs of reproduction, with their appendages
   D. A vessel for conveying passengers, merchandise, etc., across streams and other narrow waters

Answer key: 1. C (His father); 2. A (Vasudeva); 3. A (The single word Om); 4. B (Serenity); 5. C (Walks into the forest to die); 6. C (The flower of a plant, or the essential organs of reproduction, with their appendages); 7. B (Having the power of serving or accomplishing fate)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.4, W.7.1): In “Om,” how does Hesse show hearing the many voices? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Om develops the idea of hearing the many voices. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in Om to complicate the reader's understanding of hearing the many voices. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Om within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of hearing the many voices responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Om as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of hearing the many voices. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *He no longer used the ferryboat, his eyes were starting to get weak, and not just his eyes; his arms and hands as well.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "ferryboat" most nearly mean?

   A. Act of taking a bath or baths
   B. The act of one who, or that which, weaves
   C. To sound loudly
   D. A vessel for conveying passengers, merchandise, etc., across streams and other narrow waters

2. *Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was. It was nothing but a readiness of the soul, an ability, a secret art, to think every moment, while living his life, the thought of oneness, to be able to feel and inhale the oneness. Slowly this blossomed in him, was shining back at him from Vasudeva's old, childlike face: harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Om"?

   A. Hearing the many voices
   B. The letter
   C. Injustice and the burden of silence
   D. Obsession and the discovery of life

SAT key: 1. D (A vessel for conveying passengers, merchandise, etc., across streams and other narrow waters); 2. A (Hearing the many voices)

Lesson 12: Govinda

Focus: wisdom cannot be taught

Teacher only · spoilers

Old Govinda, still searching, comes to the ferry and asks for teaching. Siddhartha says that wisdom cannot be communicated in words, that every truth's opposite is also true, and that one must love the world. Asked to kiss Siddhartha's forehead, Govinda sees in his face a stream of countless faces and forms—the unity of all things—and bows, weeping, before his friend's smile.

Background: The ending echoes Buddhist ideas of non-self and the Hindu idea of the oneness of reality.

Significance: The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are insights, benevolently, searcher, bizarre, progressed. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "But haven't you found something by yourself, though you've found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?" Webster's says: A sight or view of the interior of anything. Now the word history: "insight": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "benevolent": bene- (Latin bene, "well") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "searcher": se- (Latin se-, "apart") + -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. The ending echoes Buddhist ideas of non-self and the Hindu idea of the oneness of reality. Why does this chapter matter? The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for theme.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see theme, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to wisdom cannot be taught.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Theme, Characterization, Irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of theme. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *He came to the river and asked the old man to ferry him over, and when they got off the boat on the other side, he said to the old man: "You're very good to us monks and pilgrims, you have already ferried many of us across the river. Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Theme, Characterization, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Govinda," how does Hesse show wisdom cannot be taught? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about wisdom cannot be taught, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes wisdom cannot be taught. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
insights			

	A sight or view of the interior of anything	*But haven't you found something by yourself, though you've found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?*	"insight": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
benevolently	Having a disposition to do good	*The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he used to smile, the exalted one.*	"benevolent": bene- (Latin bene, "well") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
searcher	One who, or that which, searhes or examines	*Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*	"searcher": se- (Latin se-, "apart") + -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
bizarre	Odd in manner or appearance	*(But secretly he thought to himself: This Siddhartha is a bizarre person, he expresses bizarre thoughts, his teachings sound foolish.*	"bizarre": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
progressed	A moving or going forward	*It is not possible for any person to see how far another one has already progressed on his path; in the robber and dice-gambler, the Buddha is waiting; in the Brahmin, the robber is waiting.*	"progress": pro- (Latin pro, "forward, for"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
tolerance	The power or capacity of enduring	*He commands benevolence, clemency, sympathy, tolerance, but not love; he forbade us to tie our heart in love to earthly things."*	"tolerance": -ance (Latin -antia, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
simultaneous	Existing, happening, or done, at the same time	*In deep meditation, there is the possibility to put time out of existence, to see all life which was, is, and will be as if it was simultaneous, and there everything is good, everything is perfect, everything is Brahman.*	"simultaneous": -ous (Latin -osus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
incarnation	The act of clothing with flesh, or the state of being so clothed	*It is unlikely for one of us to see the other again in this incarnation.*	"incarnation": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
predecessor	One who precedes	*But most of all, I have learned here from this river and from my predecessor, the ferryman Vasudeva.*	"predecessor": pre- (Latin prae, "before") + cess (Latin cedere, "to go, yield") + -or (Latin -or, "one who"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

developing	To free from that which infolds or envelops	*The sinner is not on his way to become a Buddha, he is not in the process of developing, though our capacity for thinking does not know how else to picture these things.*	“develop”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who comes to the ferry at the end?
   A. Gotama
   B. Kamala
   C. Siddhartha's son
   D. Govinda
2. What does Siddhartha say about wisdom?
   A. It belongs to monks
   B. It is useless
   C. It cannot be taught in words
   D. It is in books
3. What does Siddhartha say one must do with the world?
   A. Rule it
   B. Escape it
   C. Love it
   D. Ignore it
4. What does Govinda see in Siddhartha's face?
   A. Countless faces and forms flowing together
   B. Fire
   C. Only an old man
   D. His own father
5. Whose smile does Siddhartha's resemble?
   A. Kamala's
   B. Gotama's

C. Vasudeva's only

D. His son's

6. In the line “But haven’t you found something by yourself, though you’ve found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?”, what does “insights” most nearly mean?

   A. Odd in manner or appearance

   B. A sight or view of the interior of anything

   C. Having a disposition to do good

   D. One who, or that which, searhes or examines

7. In the line “The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he used to smile, the exalted one.”, what does “benevolently” most nearly mean?

   A. Odd in manner or appearance

   B. A sight or view of the interior of anything

   C. Having a disposition to do good

   D. One who, or that which, searhes or examines

Answer key: 1. D (Govinda); 2. C (It cannot be taught in words); 3. C (Love it); 4. A (Countless faces and forms flowing together); 5. B (Gotama's); 6. B (A sight or view of the interior of anything); 7. C (Having a disposition to do good)

Writing prompts (five rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.2, W.7.1): In “Govinda,” how does Hesse show wisdom cannot be taught? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

High School / Common Core (450 words; RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Govinda develops the idea of wisdom cannot be taught. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses theme in Govinda to complicate the reader's understanding of wisdom cannot be taught. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Govinda within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of wisdom cannot be taught responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Govinda as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of wisdom cannot be taught. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches),

account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*

   As used in the text, what does the word "searcher" most nearly mean?

   A. The act of clothing with flesh, or the state of being so clothed
   B. One who precedes
   C. One who, or that which, searhes or examines
   D. To free from that which infolds or envelops

2. *He came to the river and asked the old man to ferry him over, and when they got off the boat on the other side, he said to the old man: "You're very good to us monks and pilgrims, you have already ferried many of us across the river. Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Govinda"?

   A. Doubts and preparations
   B. Happiness for Jane
   C. The letter
   D. Wisdom cannot be taught

SAT key: 1. C (One who, or that which, searhes or examines); 2. D (Wisdom cannot be taught)

Whole-book test

Siddhartha: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. What is Siddhartha's family background?
   A. He is a merchant's son
   B. He is the son of a Brahmin
   C. He is a ferryman's son
   D. He is a prince
2. What do the Samanas practice?
   A. Farming
   B. Trading goods
   C. Warfare
   D. Fasting and self-denial
3. Where do they hear Gotama teach?
   A. In a palace
   B. In the grove of Jetavana
   C. In a city market
   D. By the river
4. What does Siddhartha resolve to learn from?
   A. The Samanas
   B. The Buddha
   C. Himself
   D. His father
5. Who ferries Siddhartha across the river?
   A. Kamaswami
   B. Gotama
   C. Vasudeva
   D. Govinda
6. How does Siddhartha treat business?
   A. As a game he does not take seriously
   B. As sacred work
   C. As a burden he hates
   D. As a way to help the poor
7. What happens to Siddhartha over the years in the city?
   A. He becomes poor

B. He becomes greedy and weary

C. He becomes a ferryman

D. He becomes a holy man

8. What does Siddhartha intend to do at the river?

A. Bathe

B. Fish

C. Drown himself

D. Cross it

9. Whose assistant does Siddhartha become?

A. Gotama's

B. Govinda's

C. Kamaswami's

D. Vasudeva's

10. How does the son treat Siddhartha?

A. With love

B. With fear

C. With silence

D. With contempt

11. Whom does Siddhartha's reflection resemble?

A. His son

B. Govinda

C. His father

D. Gotama

12. Who comes to the ferry at the end?

A. Gotama

B. Kamala

C. Siddhartha's son

D. Govinda

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how the search for self-knowledge develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
2. Explain how experience versus teaching develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
3. Explain how the unity of all things develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the novel's central concerns (the search for self-knowledge, experience versus teaching, the unity of all things, the river and time, love and attachment) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. B (He is the son of a Brahmin); 2. D (Fasting and self-denial); 3. B (In the grove of Jetavana); 4. C (Himself); 5. C (Vasudeva); 6. A (As a game he does not take seriously); 7. B (He becomes greedy and weary); 8. C (Drown himself); 9. D (Vasudeva's); 10. D (With contempt); 11. C (His father); 12. D (Govinda)

Essay assignments

Essay: The search for self-knowledge

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the search for self-knowledge. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

High School / Common Core (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the search for self-knowledge across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Hermann Hesse uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the search for self-knowledge in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Experience versus teaching

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about experience versus teaching. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

High School / Common Core (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops experience versus teaching across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Hermann Hesse uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of experience versus teaching in Siddhartha. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of experience versus teaching in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on experience versus teaching in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The unity of all things

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the unity of all things. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

High School / Common Core (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the unity of all things across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Hermann Hesse uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of the unity of all things in Siddhartha. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the unity of all things in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the unity of all things in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The river and time

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the river and time. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

High School / Common Core (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the river and time across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Hermann Hesse uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of the river and time in Siddhartha. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the river and time in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the river and time in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Love and attachment

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about love and attachment. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

High School / Common Core (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops love and attachment across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Hermann Hesse uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of love and attachment in Siddhartha. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of love and attachment in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on love and attachment in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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